



Vought F4U Corsair
1943

Fast and highly maneuverable, single-engine fighter-bomber planes such as the Corsair were in great demand during World War II.

light aluminum body

fully retractable landing gear

Lockheed F-117A Nighthawk
1982

Stealth aircraft such as the Nighthawk are designed to avoid detection by enemy radar. They are shaped and colored to diffract and reflect radar waves indistinctly.



metal body

faceted body shape

narrow, streamlined fuselage

triangular wings, roundly tapered at the ends

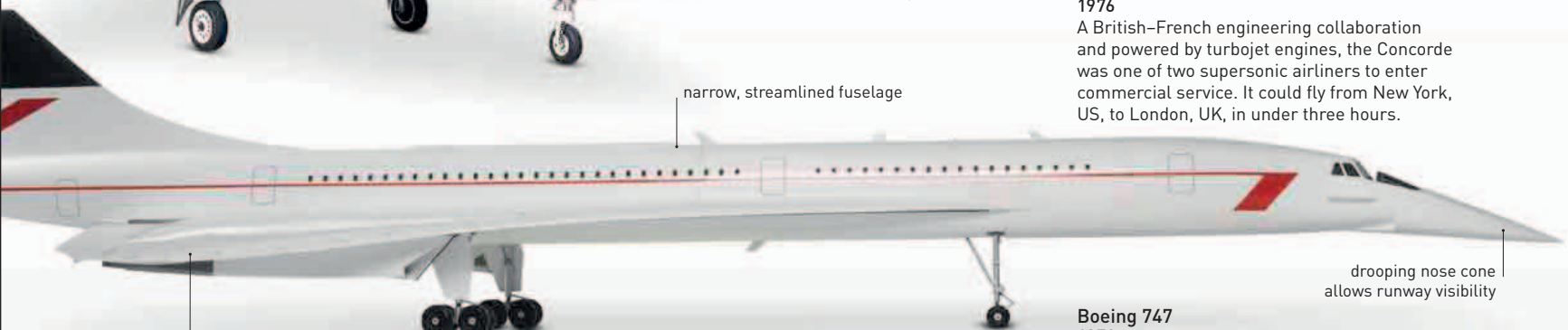


foldable wings

wing float

Concorde
1976

A British-French engineering collaboration and powered by turbojet engines, the Concorde was one of two supersonic airliners to enter commercial service. It could fly from New York, US, to London, UK, in under three hours.



drooping nose cone allows runway visibility

Boeing 747
1970

Until it was surpassed by the A380 in 2007, the Boeing 747 was the world's biggest airliner, with the capacity to carry up to 680 passengers.



wide body

high-power, low-fuel-consumption turbofan engine

tailfin provides directional stability

US Space Shuttle
1982

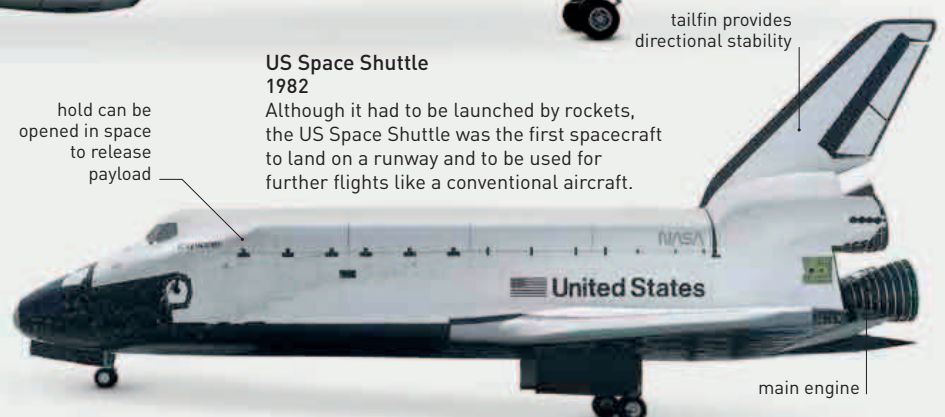
Although it had to be launched by rockets, the US Space Shuttle was the first spacecraft to land on a runway and to be used for further flights like a conventional aircraft.

hold can be opened in space to release payload

long, thin wing reduces drag

Schleicher ASK13
1966

Made using strong, ultralight modern materials, gliders can fly far and high, using rising air currents for lift.



main engine